CLASS 9 ENGLISH — READING SKILL PAPER SET 06

Reading Comprehension | RBSE Board Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 45 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 20**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Section A has one passage with 12 questions (1 mark each).
3. Section B has one case-based passage with 8 questions (1 mark each).
4. Questions include MCQs and short answers of 30–40 words.
5. Write the question number before each answer.
6. Answers must be written in the answer book in the order of the questions.

SECTION — A (Reading Comprehension: Factual / Discursive Passage, 400–450 words) 12 Marks

Read the passage and answer the questions.

1. *Read the passage carefully and answer the questions that follow.* 12

Every village in India has a story hidden in its skyline. A temple spire, a well, a banyan tree and a school building form a small family of places where people meet. These places teach us something that no textbook can: that a community survives because its members look after shared things.

Consider the village pond. In many places it was dug by the people themselves and cleaned each year before the rains. It gave water to cattle, a place for children to swim and a cool spot for elders to talk in the evening. Today, in many places, ponds are filled with garbage or built over. When this happens, the village loses not only water but also a meeting place.

Look closely and every part of that skyline tells a story of its own. The well recalls a time when the whole village gathered at dawn, and the talk at its edge was the village's newspaper. The banyan marks the spot where elders settled disputes and children listened to tales. The temple or mosque spire records the faith of generations, and the school, the newest of the four, records the hope that tomorrow will be wider than yesterday.

When a village is modernised carelessly, these landmarks are the first to be lost. A road is widened and the old tree is cut; a concrete tank replaces the well; a loud speaker drowns the evening bell. Planners who want progress without loss must first walk through the village and listen to its people, for the people alone know which stones are only stones and which hold memory.

Children who grow up reading the skyline learn to treat their surroundings as a book rather than a backdrop. A class that draws a map of its village, interviews the oldest resident and records the history of the temple tank learns more about civics, geography and history than a month of lessons can teach. Such projects give young people a reason to stay connected with their roots, even when they leave for the city. A village that remembers its own story is never entirely poor, and a student who can tell it is never entirely a stranger anywhere.

Some villages have shown another path. In one village, youth groups have cleaned the pond, planted trees around it and put up a signboard asking visitors to keep it clean. Within two years, birds returned, and a weekly market began on its bank. The lesson is that public places stay alive only when ordinary people take responsibility for them.

(i) The writer says that village places teach us that: 1

(a) textbooks are useless **(b)** temples are the oldest

(c) a community survives by caring for shared things **(d)** wells are needed

(ii) A village pond was used for all EXCEPT: 1

(a) running a factory **(b)** watering cattle
(c) elders talking **(d)** children swimming

(iii) When ponds are filled with garbage, a village loses: 1
(a) only birds **(b)** only a path
(c) only trees **(d)** water and a meeting place

(iv) The youth groups did all of these EXCEPT: 1
(a) cleaned the pond **(b)** put up a signboard
(c) planted trees **(d)** sold the pond

(v) What returned to the village after two years? 1
(a) factories **(b)** birds **(c)** snakes **(d)** floods

(vi) Name two places that form the village's skyline. 1

(vii) How did the villagers earlier keep the pond clean? 1

(viii) What began on the pond's bank? 1

(ix) Find a word that means 'something shared by all people'. 1

(x) What is the lesson of the passage? 1

(xi) According to the passage, the talk at the village well was like the village's: 1
(a) school **(b)** market **(c)** court **(d)** newspaper

(xii) What should planners do before changing a village? 1

SECTION — B (Reading Comprehension: Case-based Passage, 200–250 words) — 8 Marks

Read the text and answer the questions.

2. *Read the following case and answer the questions that follow.* 8

The advertisement below appeared in a local newspaper.

SUNRISE COMPUTER INSTITUTE, KOTA

Summer Course for School Students — Learn to Code in 30 Days!

The course is meant for students of Classes 8 to 12 and will begin on 2 June. Classes will be held for two hours a day, from 10 a.m. to 12 noon, from Monday to Friday. Students will learn the basics of computers, simple programming in Python and how to create a website. Each batch will have only twenty students so that every learner receives personal attention. All study material and laboratory use are included in the fee of ₹3,500.

A discount of 20 per cent is offered to students who register before 15 May, and an extra 10 per cent concession is given to girl students. A certificate will be awarded to every student who completes the course with at least 80 per cent attendance, and the three best projects will win prizes. For admission, contact the institute at 22, Station Road, Kota, between 9 a.m. and 5 p.m., or visit its website. Seats are limited and are allotted on a first-come, first-served basis.

Students who wish to try before enrolling may attend a free demonstration class on 25 May at 4 p.m., where the faculty will answer questions from parents and show some projects completed by earlier batches.

(i) The course is meant for students of: 1
(a) Classes 8 to 12 **(b)** Class 12 only
(c) Classes 5 to 8 **(d)** Classes 1 to 5

(ii) How many students will be there in each batch? 1
(a) Fifty **(b)** Ten **(c)** Twenty **(d)** Thirty

(iii) The fee for the course is: 1
(a) ₹5,000 **(b)** ₹3,500 **(c)** ₹2,000 **(d)** ₹350

(iv) A certificate is given to students who have at least: 1

(a) 90 per cent marks **(b)** 80 per cent attendance

(c) 50 per cent attendance **(d)** full attendance

(v) For how many hours a day will classes be held? 1

(vi) Who gets the extra concession? 1

(vii) Name two things students will learn. 1

(viii) How are seats allotted? 1

END OF QUESTION PAPER **Total: 20 Marks**

MASTERMIND